

The Hebrew Alefbet and the English Alphabet

Shared descent from Phoenician, via Greek and Latin (English) or Paleo-Hebrew and Ketav Ashuri (Hebrew)

Hebrew	Name	Phoenician	Meaning	Greek	English
א	Aleph	𐤀 Alep	ox	Alpha (Α)	A
ב	Bet	𐤁 Bet	house	Beta (Β)	B
ג	Gimel	𐤂 Gimel	camel	Gamma (Γ)	C, G
ד	Dalet	𐤃 Dalet	door	Delta (Δ)	D
ה	He	𐤄 He	window	Epsilon (Ε)	E
ו	Vav	𐤅 Waw	hook	Digamma (F)	F, V
ז	Zayin	𐤆 Zayin	weapon	Zeta (Ζ)	Z
ח	Het	𐤇 Heth	fence	Eta (Η)	H
ט	Tet	𐤈 Teth	wheel	Theta (Θ)	—
י	Yod	𐤉 Yod	hand	Iota (Ι)	I
כ	Kaf	𐤊 Kaph	palm	Kappa (Κ)	K
ל	Lamed	𐤌 Lamed	ox goad	Lambda (Λ)	L
מ	Mem	𐤍 Mem	water	Mu (Μ)	M
נ	Nun	𐤎 Nun	fish	Nu (Ν)	N
ס	Samekh	𐤏 Semk	fish/support	Xi (Ξ)	—
ע	Ayin	𐤐 Ayin	eye	Omicron (Ο)	O*
פ	Pe	𐤑 Pe	mouth	Pi (Π)	P
צ	Tsadi	𐤒 Sade	uncertain	—	—
ק	Qof	𐤓 Qoph	back of head	Koppa (Ϟ)	Q
ר	Resh	𐤔 Resh	head	Rho (Ρ)	R
ש	Shin	𐤕 Shin	tooth	Sigma (Σ)	S
ת	Tav	𐤖 Taw	mark	Tau (Τ)	T
—	—	—	—	—	J
—	—	—	—	—	U
—	—	—	—	—	W

* O appears in the English column because Greek repurposed the ayin letter shape as a vowel. Ayin itself remains a consonant in Hebrew throughout. Classical Latin had 23 letters and did not include J, U, or W.